

Shutdown looms with much at stake

Senate Democrats demand changes to ICE operations

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The nation is facing another government shutdown starting Saturday as nearly all Senate Democrats vow to oppose a funding package unless it contains changes to how immigration officers operate in the aftermath of last weekend's fatal shooting by federal agents in Minneapolis.

Democrats and Republi-

cans insist they don't want another shutdown — even a partial one, as this would be — after the record-long closure last fall. And they were close to avoiding a repeat last week when the final set of six appropriations bills for the current fiscal year made it through bipartisan negotiations and passed the House.

But the fatal shooting of Alex Pretti by border patrol officers has upset the political dynamic and sent Congress veering toward another funding showdown. A pivotal Senate procedural vote is set for

DHS, Page A7

'It just feels very real, these tactics they're using to intimidate.'

A SOUTH PORTLAND WOMAN WHO DID NOT GIVE HER FULL NAME

Could Big Brother be watching?

ICE protesters say they've been threatened with terror list, database of details



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Members of Maine Lawyers for the Rule of Law marched in Portland last week.

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — Protesters and legal observers who have confronted and clashed with federal immigration agents say they have been threatened with retaliation and suspect the government is keeping tabs on them as a kind of official blacklisting campaign.

In one video widely circulated on social media, a Maine woman who was filming Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers in Portland last week noticed one agent had taken a picture of the license plate on her car.

"Why are you taking my information down?" she asked.

"Because we have a nice little database, and now you're considered a domestic terrorist," the agent responded.

In other instances, people across Maine have reported observing an ICE arrest and then receiving a phone call or a knock on the door from someone purporting to be an agent, telling them they could end up on a domestic terrorist list, according to Zach Heiden, chief counsel of the ACLU of Maine.

"People are being told that their

ICE, Page A7

A year after tragedy, the pain lives on



THE SKATING CLUB OF BOSTON



DAVE BUSTON/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE



THE SKATING CLUB OF BOSTON

On Jan. 29, 2025, 67 people were killed when their flight collided with an Army helicopter in Washington. Among the victims were several people affiliated with the Skating Club of Boston: skater Spencer Lane (left); husband-and-wife coaches Evgenia Shishkova and Vadim Naumov (center); and skater Jinna Han (right) and her mother, Jin Han. Doug Lane, who also lost his wife that day, has learned about grief but has also found purpose. **B1.**

Getting the wheels turning about AI and reality (whoa!)

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Plenty of unusual stuff happens in Somerville, a place that tends to attract people with talents of all kinds, where it's hard to be the kookiest guy on the block.

But a video that was making the rounds on a Somerville Facebook page this week after the monster storm dumped nearly 2 feet of snow on the city seemed a little too good to be true.

In the short clip set to bouncy music, three people can be seen hard at work shoveling their driveway while . . . riding on unicycles. One of them was wearing a jester hat, its tassels bouncing as he pedaled.

Good, clean fun on a local Facebook page, it seemed. But something about the clip seemed off.

I'm a reporter, so I'm skeptical by nature. My eyes were drawn to the uncanny nature of what I was seeing. Did the herky-jerky movements of the people on the unicycles

UNICYCLISTS, Page A10



ALEX FELDMAN

In a video, three people did some shoveling this week while riding unicycles. Or did they?

As museum-goers' habits shift, MFA resorts to layoffs again

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

For nearly six years, the Museum of Fine Arts has fought to recover from the pandemic, implementing cost-saving measure after cost-saving measure: trimming hours, shrinking its schedule of exhibitions, and closing its entrance on the Fenway. It even raised a \$40 million cash reserve to help bridge budget shortfalls as it sought to rebuild.

But now the reserve is largely spent, and in yet another sign

of the changing habits of museum-goers and of the pandemic's lasting effect on the cultural sector, the MFA is turning to a last resort: layoffs.

Officials said Wednesday that they are cutting 33 employees and eliminating another 23 positions that are vacant — roughly 10 percent of the museum's total jobs — as part of a broader restructuring.

Pierre Terjanian, who took over as MFA director seven months ago, said layoffs are necessary now because the mu-

seum is facing a \$13 million projected deficit.

"Every year that passes, it's widening, and that's because expenses are growing at a faster rate than our revenue," Terjanian said. "At some point, the scissor effect is immense, and the gap is unbearable. We've pretty much reached that point."

He added that staff salaries and benefits account for 55 percent of museum expenses, and the cuts, which the museum

MFA, Page A10

In the end, there's no way Hall can justify keeping Belichick out

DAN SHAUGHNESSY
COMMENTARY

Ridiculous. Also petty, embarrassing, unprecedented, stupid, and preposterous.

In his first year of eligibility, Bill Belichick failed to get enough votes for induction to the Pro Football Hall of Fame.

It's a farce.

The election process is somewhat complicated. Belichick was rejected by a Hall panel of 50 voters comprised of veteran media members, plus a handful of Hall of Famers, including Bill Polian, Tony Dungy, Dan Fouts, and James Lofton. Belichick needed at least 40 votes to gain admission, but according to

an ESPN report, the Hoodie came up short and was informed of the snub by the Hall last Friday.

According to ESPN, in response to the rejection, Belichick asked associates, "Six Super Bowls wasn't enough?" and "What does a guy have to do?"

Among all NFL head coaches, dead or alive, Belichick ranks first in Super Bowl wins (six), conference championships (nine), and playoff wins (31). His 333 total wins places him second only to the late Don Shula, who won 347 for the Colts and Dolphins. As a head coach and assistant, Belichick coached 49 NFL seasons, winning eight Super Bowl rings — six with the Patriots and two as an assistant under Bill Parcells with the Giants.

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C2

President Trump sharply intensified his threats against Iran, suggesting that he could soon mount an attack "with speed and violence." **A3.**

Governor Maura Healey released a \$63.4 billion budget proposal that her administration said would not raise taxes or fees but would hike spending beyond inflation. **B1.**

Massachusetts has lost 33,340 more people to other states than it gained in the 12-month span that ended on July 1. **D1.**

Worries are growing that the College Board's security isn't fail-safe with signs of cheating on the new digital SAT. **A2.**



Twice bitten

Thursday: Icy, breezy. High 23-28. Low 2-7.

Friday: Even worse. High 15-20. Low -2.

Sunrise: 7:01 Sunset: 4:54

Weather and Comics, D6-7.

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